# Erfan Loweimi


**Contact Information**

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**Research Interests**

✓ Conversational AI

**Career**

- Machine Learning Engineer, CollabAI, Cisco (2025-)
- Research Fellow in Machine Learning, University of Edinburgh (2024-)
- Research Associate, University of Cambridge (2022 - 2024)
- Research Associate, King's College London (2021 - 2023)
- Research Associate, University of Edinburgh (2018 - 2021)

**Education**

Ph.D., School of Computer Science, University of Sheffield, 2018 (Thesis)
- Speech and Hearing Research Group (SPandH)
- Supervisors: Professor Jon Barker and Professor Thomas Hain

**Selected Publications**

**Journal Papers**

1. A. Núñez García, S. de la Fuente García, **E. Loweimi**, M. Masoodian, R. Vieira, A. Rodrigues, and S. Luz, "A study protocol for assessing the effects of intangible cultural heritage experiences on human well-being," PLOS ONE, Nov. 12, 2025, doi: 10.1371/journal.pone.0336120.
2. S. Hosseini, G. Chinello, G. Lindsay, E. **Loweimi**, M. A. Ansari, and D. McGlinchey, "Transfer Learning for Data-Driven Wet Gas Flow Metering: Enhancing Generalisation in Digital Measurement Systems," Flow Measurement and Instrumentation, p. 103146, 2025, doi: 10.1016/j.flowmeasinst.2025.103146.
3. Z. Yue, **E. Loweimi**, Z. Cvetkovic, J. Barker, and H. Christensen, "Raw acoustic-articulatory multimodal dysarthric speech recognition," Computer Speech & Language, vol. 95, Art. no. 101839, 2026, doi: 10.1016/j.csl.2025.101839.
4. G. Wu, A. Haider, X. Tian, **E. Loweimi**, Ch-H.Chan, M. Qian, A. Muhammad, I. Spence, R. Cooper, W.W.Y. Ng, J. Kittler, M. Gales and H. Wang, "Multi-modal Video Search by Examples – A Video Quality Impact Analysis," IET Computer Vision, pp. 1–17, 2024, doi: 10.1049/cvi2.12303.
5. **E. Loweimi**, A. Carmantini, P. Bell, S. Renals and Z. Cvetkovic, "Phonetic Error Analysis Beyond Phone Error Rate," IEEE/ACM Transactions on Audio, Speech and Language Processing, vol. 31, pp. 3346-3361, 2023.
6. **E. Loweimi**, Z. Yue, P. Bell, S. Renals and Z. Cvetkovic, "Multi-stream Acoustic Modelling using Raw Real and Imaginary Parts of the Fourier Transform," IEEE/ACM Transactions on Audio, Speech and Language Processing, vol. 31, pp. 876-890, 2023.
7. Z. Yue*, **E. Loweimi***, J. Barker, H. Christensen and Z. Cvetkovic, "Acoustic Modelling from Raw Source and Filter Components for Dysarthric Speech Recognition," IEEE/ACM Transactions on Audio, Speech and Language Processing, vol. 30, pp. 2968-2980, 2022 (* Equal contribution).

**Conference Papers**

1. **E. Loweimi**, Z. Yue, A. Carmantini, Z. Cvetkovic, S. Renals, and P. Bell, "Phonetic Error Analysis of Raw Waveform Acoustic Models", *INTERSPEECH*, 2026.

2. **E. Loweimi**, M. Qian, K. Knill, G. Wu, C-H. Chan, A. Haider, M. Awan, J. Kittler, H. Wang, and M. Gales, "To Be Multimodal or Not to Be: Query-Adaptive Audio-Visual Person Retrieval via Active Modality Detection", *INTERSPEECH*, 2026.

3. X. Wu, Z. Yue, **E. Loweimi**, and J. Williams, "Towards Dys-XAI: Influence-Based Explanations for Dysarthria Severity Assessment", *INTERSPEECH*, 2026.

4. **E. Loweimi**, S. De La Fonte Garcia, and S. Luz, "Predicting Psychological Well-Being from Spontaneous Speech using LLMs", *EMBC*, 2026.

5. Z. Yue, D. Kayande, Z. Cvetkovic, and **E. Loweimi**, "Probing Whisper for Dysarthric Speech in Detection and Assessment", *ICASSP*, 2026.

6. K. Fatehi, A. Shirian, and **E. Loweimi**, "FinHuBERT: Hierarchical Feature Imitating Networks for Low-Resource Speech Recognition", *ICASSP*, 2026.

7. **E. Loweimi**, S. De La Fonte Garcia, and S. Luz, "Zero-Shot Speech-Based Depression and Anxiety Assessment with LLMs", *INTERSPEECH*, 2025.

8. Z. Yue, et al, "Challenges and Practical Guidelines for Atypical Speech Data Collection, Annotation, Usage and Sharing: A Multi-project Perspective", *INTERSPEECH*, 2025.

9. **E. Loweimi**, M. Qian, K. Knill and M. Gales, "On the Usefulness of Speaker Embeddings for Speaker Retrieval in the Wild: A Comparative Study of x-vector and ECAPA-TDNN Models," *INTERSPEECH*, 2024.

10. M. Qian, R. Ma, A. Liusie, **E. Loweimi**, K. Knill, and M. Gales, "Zero-shot Audio Topic Reranking using Large Language Models", *SLT*, 2024.

11. Z. Yue*, **E. Loweimi*** and Z. Cvetkovic, "Dysarthric Speech Recognition, Detection and Classification using Raw Phase and Magnitude Spectra," *INTERSPEECH*, 2023 (* Equal contribution).

12. Z. Yue*, **E. Loweimi***, J. Barker, H. Christensen and Z. Cvetkovic, "Dysarthric Speech Recognition from Raw Waveform with Parametric CNNs," *INTERSPEECH*, 2022 (* Equal contribution).

13. N. Shao, **E. Loweimi** and X. Li, "RCT: Random Consistency Training for Semi-supervised Sound Event Detection," *INTERSPEECH*, 2022.

14. Z. Yue*, **E. Loweimi*** and Z. Cvetkovic, "Raw Source and Filter Modelling for Dysarthric Speech Recognition," *ICASSP*, 2022 (* Equal contribution).

15. Z. Yue, **E. Loweimi**, Z. Cvetkovic, H. Christensen and J. Barker, "Multimodal Acoustic-Articulatory Feature Fusion for Dysarthric Speech Recognition," *ICASSP*, 2022.

16. **E. Loweimi**, P. Bell and S. Renals, "Speech Acoustic Modelling using Raw Source and Filter Components," *INTERSPEECH*, 2021.

17. S. Zhang, **E. Loweimi**, P. Bell and S. Renals, "Stochastic Attention Head Removal: A Simple and Effective Method for Improving Transformer Based ASR Models," *INTERSPEECH*, 2021.

18. **E. Loweimi**, Z. Cvetkovic, P. Bell and S. Renals, "Speech Acoustic Modelling from Raw Phase Spectrum," *ICASSP*, 2021.

19. S. Zhang, C-T. Do, R. Doddipatla, **E. Loweimi**, P. Bell and S. Renals, "Train your classifier first: Cascade Neural Networks Training from Upper Layers to Lower Layers," *ICASSP*, 2021.

20. **E. Loweimi**, P. Bell and S. Renals, "Raw Sign and Magnitude Spectra for Multi-head Acoustic Modelling," *INTERSPEECH*, 2020.

21. **E. Loweimi**, P. Bell and S. Renals, "On the Robustness and Training Dynamics of Raw Waveform Models," *INTERSPEECH*, 2020.

22. S. Zhang, **E. Loweimi**, P. Bell, S. Renals, "When Can Self-Attention Be Replaced by Feed Forward Layers?," *SLT*, 2020.

23. J. Fainberg, O. Klejch, **E. Loweimi**, P. Bell, S. Renals, "Acoustic Model Adaptation from Raw Waveforms with SincNet," *ASRU*, 2019.

24. **E. Loweimi**, P. Bell and S. Renals, "On Learning Interpretable CNNs with Parametric Modulated Kernel-based Filters," *INTERSPEECH*, 2019.

25. S. Zhang, **E. Loweimi**, Y. Xu, P. Bell, S. Renals "Trainable Dynamic Subsampling for End-to-End Speech Recognition," *INTERSPEECH*, 2019.

26. M.A. Jalal, **E. Loweimi**, R. Moore and T. Hain, "Learning Temporal Clusters Using Capsule Routing for Speech Emotion Recognition," *INTERSPEECH*, 2019.

27. **E. Loweimi**, P. Bell and S. Renals, "On the Usefulness of Statistical Normalisation of Bottleneck Features for Speech Recognition," *ICASSP*, 2019.

28. S. Zhang, **E. Loweimi**, P. Bell, S. Renals,"Windowed Attention Mechanisms for Speech Recognition," *ICASSP*, 2019.

29. **E. Loweimi**, J. Barker and T. Hain, "On the Usefulness of the Speech Phase Spectrum for Pitch Extraction," *INTERSPEECH*, 2018.

30. **E. Loweimi**, J. Barker and T. Hain, "Exploring the use of Group Delay for Generalised VTS based Noise Compensation," *ICASSP*, 2018.

31. **E. Loweimi**, J. Barker and T. Hain, "Channel Compensation in the Generalised Vector Taylor Series Approach to Robust ASR," *INTERSPEECH*, 2017.

32. **E. Loweimi**, J. Barker, O. Saz Torralba and T. Hain, "Robust Source-Filter Separation of Speech Signal in the Phase Domain," *INTERSPEECH*, 2017.

33. **E. Loweimi**, J. Barker and T. Hain, "Statistical Normalisation of Phase-based Feature Representation for Robust Speech Recognition," *ICASSP*, 2017.

34. **E. Loweimi**, J. Barker and T. Hain, "Use of Generalised Nonlinearity in VTS Noise Compensation for Robust Speech Recognition," *INTERSPEECH*, 2016.

35. **E. Loweimi**, J. Barker and T. Hain, "Source-filter Separation of Speech Signal in the Phase Domain," *INTERSPEECH*, 2015.

36. **E. Loweimi**, S.M. Ahadi and T. Drugman, "A New Phase-based Feature Representation for Robust Speech Recognition," *ICASSP*, 2013.

37. **E. Loweimi**, S.M. Ahadi, T. Drugman and S. Loveymi, "On the Importance of Pre-emphasis and Window Shape in Phase-based Speech Recognition," Lecture Notes in Computer Science, vol. 7911 LNAI, 2013.

38. **E. Loweimi**, S.M. Ahadi and H. Sheikhzadeh, "Phase-only Speech Reconstruction Using Very Short Frames," *INTERSPEECH*, 2011.

39. **E. Loweimi** and S.M. Ahadi, "A New Group Delay-based Feature for Robust Speech Recognition," *ICME*, 2011.

40. **E. Loweimi**, S.M. Ahadi and S. Loveymi, "On the Importance of Phase and Magnitude Spectra in Speech Enhancement," *ICEE*, 2011.

41. **E. Loweimi** and S.M. Ahadi, "Objective Evaluation of Magnitude and Phase only Spectrum-based Reconstruction of the Speech Signal," *ISCCSP*, 2010.

## Under Review / arXiv

**Journal Papers**

1. **E. Loweimi**, H. Daneshvar, S. Loveymi, S. Ouelha, Z. Yue, H. Mozaffar, and S. Luz, "A Tutorial on Prompt Engineering: From Messy Thoughts to AI Workflows," Submitted to IEEE Access.

2. **E. Loweimi**, De La Fonte Garcia, S. Luz "Zero-Shot Speech-based Mental Health and Affective State Assessment Using LLMs," *Submitted to IEEE Journal of Selected Topics in Signal Processing.*

3. **E. Loweimi**, M. Qian, K. Knill, M. Gales "Speaker Retrieval in the Wild: Challenges, Effectiveness and Robustness," *Submitted to Speech Communication*, 2nd round.

4. **E. Loweimi***, Z. Yue*, Z. Cvetkovic "Deep Scattering Spectrum for Dysarthric Speech Recognition, Detection and Classification," *Submitted to Computer Speech & Language*, 2nd round (* Equal contribution).

5. K. Fatehi, **E. Loweimi**, S. Ouelha, N. Cummins "Finite Scalar Quantisation for Speech Representations: Dimensionality Matters More Than Codebook Size," *Submitted to Computer Speech & Language*, 2nd round.

## arXiv

1. **E. Loweimi**, S. De La Fonte Garcia, S. Loveymi, H. Daneshvar, and S. Luz "Can We Trust LLMs for Mental Health Screening? Consistency, ASR Robustness, and Evidence Faithfulness," *arXiv*.

## Awards

- Outstanding Reviewer Award, ICASSP, 2022
- Research Communicator of the Year Award, University of Sheffield, 2017
- ISCA Student Travel Grant, INTERSPEECH, 2017
- Faculty PhD Scholarship (2013-2017), Faculty of Engineering, University of Sheffield

## Teaching Experience

**Teaching Assistant** (Two semesters each)

- Postgraduate
  - Machine Learning and Adaptive Intelligence
  - Speech Technology
  - Speech Processing
- Undergraduate
  - Data-driven Computing
  - Electronics II

## Selected Oral Presentations

**Tutorial Talks**

- **E. Loweimi** and S. Loveymi, "Recent Advances in Interpreting and Understanding DNNs", Machine Vision & Image Processing (MVIP) Conference, 2022, Iran.
- Internal Tutorial

- Contrastive Learning, Deep Scattering Spectrum, Transformers, Overparameterisation in DNNs (three sessions), Raw Waveform Acoustic Modelling (four sessions), Capsule Neural Networks, Information Bottleneck, Kernel methods in ASR

**Research Talks**

- From Speech to Insight: Foundation Models for Qualitative Analysis and Mental Health Research
  - Usher Institute, University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh, UK, 2025
- Speaker Retrieval in the Wild: Challenges, Effectiveness, Robustness
  - BBC Broadcasting House, London, UK, 2024
  - University of Cambridge, Cambridge, UK, 2024
- Speech Acoustic Modelling from Raw Signal Representations
  - Edinburgh Napier University, Edinburgh, UK, 2022
- CSTR Talk, University of Edinburgh (Internal)
  - Speaker Retrieval in the Wild: Challenges, Effectiveness, Robustness, 2025
  - Phonetic Error Analysis beyond Phone Error Rater, 2023
  - On the Robustness and Training Dynamics of Raw Waveform Models, 2021
  - Raw Sign and Magnitude Spectra for Multi-head Acoustic Modelling, 2020
  - Understanding and Interpreting DNNs for Speech Recognition, 2019
  - Speech Phase Spectrum: Love It or Leave It?, 2018
- DNN Statistical Interpretation and Normalisation for ASR
  - Qatar Computing Research Institute (QCRI), Doha, Qatar, 2019
- Channel Compensation in the Generalised VTS Approach to Robust ASR
  - UKSpeech, Cambridge, UK, 2017 INTERSPEECH, Sweden, 2017
- Source-filter Separation of Speech Signal in the Phase Domain
  - UKSpeech 2015, Norwich, UK, 2015

**Other Talks**

- AI: From Zero to Aha!
  - Business School, University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh, UK, 2025
- Genie in the mike! The Science of Talking (with) Machines
  - A Pint of Science Festival, Sheffield, UK. 15, May, 2017; Teaser
- Signal Processing is Dead(?)! Long Live DNN!
  - Machine Intelligence for Natural Interfaces (MINI) workshop, Sheffield, 2016
- Deep Learning, The End of History and The Last Computer Scientist
  - A Pint of Science Festival, Sheffield, 2016
- Ethics in Data Modelling; Love it or Leave it?
  - Research Ethics and Integrity module, University of Sheffield, 2014

## Roles

- Elected Member of IEEE Speech and Language Processing Technical Committee (SLTC) (2027-2029)
- Meta Reviewer, ICASSP 2027
- Low-Resource Audio Codec (LRAC) 2.0 Challenge Organizing Committee, Signal Processing Grand Challenge, ICASSP 2027

- Publication Chair, IEEE International Conference on Audio, Speech, and Language Intelligence (ASLI), 2027
- Meta Reviewer (Speech Recognition), ICASSP 2026
- Lead Area Chair (Speech Recognition), INTERSPEECH 2025
- Meta Reviewer (Speech Recognition), ICASSP 2025
- Area Chair (Speech Recognition), INTERSPEECH 2024
- Meta Reviewer (Speech Analysis), ICASSP 2024
- UK and Ireland Speech (UKIS) Steering Committee Member (2024-)
- UK and Ireland Speech (UKIS) Conference Co-organiser, Cambridge, UK, 2024
- Area Chair (Speech and Multimodality), EMNLP 2023
- Area Chair (Speech Recognition), INTERSPEECH 2023
- Meta Reviewer (Speech Analysis), ICASSP 2023
- Associate Member of IEEE's Speech & Language Processing Technical Committee (SLTC) (2023-2026)
- Cambridge Engineering Dep. Speech Group Seminars Co-organiser 2023-2024
- Reviewer (INTERSPEECH, ICASSP, ASRU, SLT, Speech Communication, ITASLP)
- Scientific Committee Member of ICASSP 2023 AMHAT Workshop
- Publication Chair in Spoken Language Technology Workshop (SLT) 2022
- Session Chair (ICASSP, INTERSPEECH, SLT)
- Co-supervising one PhD student, University of Edinburgh (2018-2021)
- Primary supervisor of four MSc students, University of Edinburgh (2019-2021)
- Examiner of more than 15 MSc dissertations, University of Edinburgh (2019-2021)
- UKSpeech 2016 Co-organiser, Sheffield, UK, 2016
- Speech and Hearing Research Group (SPandH) Seminar Co-organiser 2015-2017

## Skills

**Computer**: Python, PyTorch, Kaldi, Shell, Linux, Office, Docker, LaTeX

**Language**: English (Fluent), Arabic (Native), Persian (Native)

## Memberships

ISCA Member | IEEE Member | IEEE SPS Member

## References


✓ Mark Gales, Professor in Information Engineering
- University of Cambridge, Cambridge, UK E-mail: mjfg@eng.cam.ac.uk

✓ Zoran Cvetkovic, Professor in Signal Processing
- King's College London, London, UK E-mail: zoran.cvetkovic@kcl.ac.uk

✓ Peter Bell, Professor in Speech Technology
- University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh, UK E-mail: peter.bell@ed.ac.uk